

Ghost: A Powerful Blogging Platform



If you are on the lookout for a blogging platform, give Ghost a try. It's a simple yet powerful publishing platform that opens up the world of online journalism to you. Ghost is used by thousands of people and companies.

My encounter with Ghost, not the one from the horror stories, started when I was wandering through the Internet looking for a blogging platform for my college group, which focused more on writing rather than the several options that offer plugins to do simple things. When I navigated to the official page of Ghost (<https://ghost.org/>), all it said was, "Just a blogging platform." Ghost aims to be a simple, open source blogging platform focused on offering a good user experience.

Installation

Though it aims to be a simple platform, installation is not so simple for the average user. For a seasoned command line user, it's a cakewalk. For this demonstration, I'll be using Linux, so some of the steps will be Linux-specific. Ghost is built on *node.js*, and requires version 0.10.* (the latest stable version). For Linux, the easiest way to install *node.js* is via the available package manager, but it may or may not be the latest version. Therefore, the best way to install *node.js* is to download the latest *tar.gz* archive from <http://nodejs.org/download/> to install the latest binaries from the section 'Linux Binaries' (if you like compiling), and then download

the source code and compile. Before compiling, make sure Python is installed.

```
wget http://nodejs.org/dist/v0.10.28/node-v0.10.28.tar.gz
```

Version number may vary.

```
tar xzvf node-latest.tar.gz && cd node-v*
./configure
make
sudo make install
```

For Mac, Windows or other OSs, download the respective installer from <http://nodejs.org/download/>.

If you still face any difficulties, refer to the wiki page <https://github.com/joyent/node/wiki/Installing-Node.js-via-package-manager>

After installing *node.js*, it's time to download and set up Ghost. Before downloading, make sure you have the recommended version of *node.js*:

```
nodejs -v
```